

Individual Goal Accessibility Feedback

To score add goal items and divide by 3:

I often find myself doing things related to this goal

I frequently engage in actions that help me reach this goal

This goal comes to mind easily

1. High Goal Accessibility (avg item scores of 6.0-7.0)

Your results suggest that your goals are **highly accessible**—they come to mind easily, and you are often thinking about and acting on them. This is a strong and adaptive pattern. Research on goal pursuit shows that when goals are frequently activated in working memory, they are more likely to guide motivation, attention, and day-to-day behavior. In other words, goals that stay “top of mind” are more likely to shape what we do, how much effort we invest, and how persistent we are when challenges arise.

Your pattern suggests that you are already doing many of the things that help goals influence real-world action—engaging in goal-relevant behaviors, noticing opportunities to make progress, and keeping your aims mentally present. This puts you in a good position to translate what matters to you into sustained effort and accomplishment.

2. Moderate Goal Accessibility (avg item scores of 4.0-5.9)

Your results suggest **moderate goal accessibility**. This means that your goals are on your mind at times and do influence your actions, but not as consistently as they could. This is a common and workable pattern. Research suggests that even valued goals may fail to shape behavior if they are not regularly activated in awareness—especially in busy or distracting contexts.

The good news is that goal accessibility is often easy to strengthen. Simple strategies—such as making goals more visible in daily life, briefly reviewing them at the start of the day, or forming clear *if-then* plans (e.g., “If it’s Monday morning, then I’ll work on X”)—can increase how often goals come to mind. Small changes that keep goals mentally present can make them more likely to guide motivation and follow-through.

3. Low Goal Accessibility (avg item scores of 1.0-3.9)

Your results suggest **low goal accessibility**, meaning that your goals may not be coming to mind very often or actively guiding your behavior. This does not mean the goals are unimportant or that you lack commitment. Rather, research shows that even meaningful goals are unlikely to influence motivation, effort, or performance unless they are

sufficiently activated in our minds. Goals that stay “in the background” tend to have little impact on what we actually do day to day.

Increasing goal accessibility is often a key first step toward making progress. Strategies such as writing goals down where you’ll see them, linking them to specific daily situations, or intentionally checking in with them can help bring them into working memory more often. When goals are mentally activated, they are far more likely to shape choices, energize effort, and support meaningful change.

Overall Goal Accessibility Feedback

To score: Add goal accessibility scores for each goal and divide by the number of goals (4)

1. High Overall Goal Accessibility (avg across goals: 6.0–7.0)

Your results suggest **high overall goal accessibility** across your goals. Taken together, your goals tend to stay “top of mind” and are frequently activated in your awareness. Research on goal pursuit and self-regulation shows that when multiple goals are mentally accessible, they are more likely to guide attention, energize motivation, and shape day-to-day behavior across life domains.

This pattern suggests that your goal system is psychologically active rather than dormant. You are likely noticing opportunities to act in goal-consistent ways, keeping relevant aims in working memory, and translating intentions into behavior. When accessibility is high across goals, effort and persistence tend to be more reliable, and people often experience a stronger sense of intentionality in their daily lives.

To maintain this strength, it can be useful to periodically check whether your goals remain appropriately prioritized and balanced. While high accessibility is generally adaptive, ensuring that attention is not spread too thin across competing goals can help preserve focus and prevent overload.

2. Moderate Overall Goal Accessibility (avg across goals: 4.0–5.9)

Your results suggest **moderate overall goal accessibility**. This means that, on average, your goals come to mind and influence your actions at times, but not as consistently as they could. Some goals may be readily accessible, while others remain more in the background. This is a common and workable pattern, especially in complex or demanding environments.

At this level, goals may guide behavior when circumstances naturally cue them, but fail to do so in busy, stressful, or distracting contexts. Research suggests that even highly valued

goals require regular activation in awareness to influence effort and follow-through. When accessibility varies across goals, the overall impact of your goal system may feel uneven.

If your individual goals differ widely in accessibility, it is often most effective to focus on the specific goals that are least mentally present, rather than trying to increase accessibility across all goals at once. Simple strategies—such as linking goals to daily routines, using brief reminders, or forming if-then plans—can selectively strengthen accessibility where it is most needed.

3. Low Overall Goal Accessibility (avg across goals: 1.0–3.9)

Your results suggest **low overall goal accessibility** across your goals. Taken together, your goals may not be coming to mind very often or actively guiding your behavior. Importantly, this does not mean your goals lack importance or that you are uncommitted. Research consistently shows that even meaningful and valued goals have little influence on behavior unless they are sufficiently activated in awareness.

Low overall accessibility often reflects a goal system that remains psychologically inactive much of the time. In such cases, daily choices may be driven more by immediate demands or habits than by longer-term aims. Over time, this can make it difficult to translate intentions into sustained effort or meaningful change.

If there is substantial variation across your goals, it is usually most productive to begin with the goals that are least accessible, rather than trying to overhaul your entire goal system. Making those goals more visible, linking them to specific situations, or building in regular check-ins can increase their presence in working memory. As goals become more mentally accessible, they are far more likely to shape choices, energize effort, and support progress across life domains.

Individual Goal Perceived Progress

To score add goal items and divide by 3:

I'm satisfied with the progress I have made on this goal so far

So far, I've been successful with this goal

I'm happy with how fast I'm moving toward this goal

1. High Perceived Goal Progress (avg item scores of 6.0–7.0)

Your results suggest that you perceive **strong progress** toward this goal. This is a highly adaptive and motivating pattern. Research on goal pursuit consistently shows that perceived progress is a powerful driver of motivation, positive affect, and self-efficacy.

When people believe they are moving forward, they tend to feel more energized, confident, and willing to persist—even when effort is required.

This pattern suggests that your efforts feel meaningfully connected to outcomes. You are likely experiencing regular feedback that signals “this is working,” which reinforces continued engagement. High perceived progress often creates a virtuous cycle: progress boosts confidence and motivation, which in turn supports further progress. Over time, this can help goals become more self-sustaining and integrated into daily routines or even one’s sense of identity.

At this stage, it can be helpful to **consolidate what’s working**—maintaining the behaviors, routines, or strategies that are producing progress. Some people also benefit from modestly refining or extending their goals (for example, setting a new benchmark or complementary aim), but only if doing so supports long-term sustainability rather than pressure. Continuing to notice and acknowledge progress can help preserve motivation and protect against complacency.

2. Moderate Perceived Goal Progress (avg item scores of 4.0–5.9)

Your results suggest a **moderate sense of progress** toward this goal. This indicates that you see yourself moving forward, but perhaps not as steadily or clearly as you would like. This is a very common and workable pattern. Research shows that motivation is often strongest when people can detect ongoing progress, but progress signals at this level may feel intermittent or vulnerable to disruption.

This pattern suggests that the goal is attainable and that effort is paying off to some extent, yet feedback about progress may be inconsistent, delayed, or hard to interpret. As a result, motivation may fluctuate—strong at times, but more fragile when obstacles arise or competing demands take priority.

One useful strategy at this stage is to *sharpen progress signals*. This can involve setting clearer short-term milestones, tracking specific behaviors linked to the goal, or periodically reflecting on gains that might otherwise be overlooked. Strengthening the connection between effort and outcomes can increase confidence and help transform moderate progress into a more stable and motivating experience.

3. Low Perceived Goal Progress (avg item scores of 1.0–3.9)

Your results suggest **low perceived progress** toward this goal. This does not mean the goal is unimportant, unrealistic, or beyond your abilities. Rather, research on self-regulation shows that when progress is difficult to see, motivation and positive emotion often decline—even when people care deeply about the goal and are exerting effort.

Low perceived progress often occurs when goals are very large, abstract, long-term, or defined mainly by distant outcomes. In these cases, people may be working hard without receiving enough feedback to signal forward movement. Over time, this can undermine confidence and make continued effort feel discouraging or unrewarding.

A key strategy supported by goal research is to restructure the goal into smaller, more manageable sub-goals that are clearly linked to the higher-level aim. Smaller goals create more frequent opportunities to experience success and positive affect, which helps restore motivation and self-efficacy. Tracking concrete actions (what you did) rather than only outcomes (what changed) can also make progress more visible. In addition, revisiting timelines, adjusting expectations, or identifying supports and resources can help ensure the goal is structured in a way that allows progress to be noticed and felt.

When progress becomes more detectable, goals are far more likely to energize effort, sustain persistence, and support meaningful change over time.

Overall Goal Perceived Progress

To score: Add goal perceived progress scores for each goal and divide by the number of goals (4)

1. High Overall Perceived Goal Progress (avg across goals: 6.0–7.0)

Your results suggest **high overall perceived progress** across your goals. Taken together, your goals give you a strong sense of forward movement and accomplishment. Research on goal pursuit and self-regulation shows that when people experience progress across multiple goals, motivation, positive affect, and self-efficacy tend to generalize beyond any single goal, contributing to an overall sense of momentum in life.

This pattern suggests that your efforts across different areas of life feel meaningfully connected to outcomes. You are likely receiving regular feedback that signals “things are moving in the right direction,” which reinforces continued engagement. When progress is experienced across goals, it can create a broad upward motivational climate, making persistence easier even when individual goals temporarily slow or become more demanding.

To build on this strength, it can be helpful to consolidate what is working across goals—maintaining routines, strategies, or supports that reliably produce progress. Continuing to notice and acknowledge progress at the system level can help preserve motivation and protect against complacency, while still allowing flexibility as goals evolve.

2. Moderate Overall Perceived Goal Progress (avg across goals: 4.0–5.9)

Your results suggest **moderate overall progress** across your goals. This means that, on average, you see forward movement, but it may not feel consistent or evenly distributed across goals. Some goals may be progressing well, while others feel slower or more uncertain. This is a common and workable pattern, particularly when people are balancing goals with different timelines, levels of difficulty, or resource demands.

At this level, motivation may be uneven across life domains. Progress in some areas may support confidence, while stalled progress in others may dampen overall momentum. Research suggests that perceived progress is most motivating when feedback is clear and frequent; when progress signals vary across goals, the overall sense of movement can feel fragile.

If your individual goals differ substantially in perceived progress, it is often most useful to focus on the specific goals with the weakest progress signals, rather than trying to increase progress everywhere at once. Clarifying milestones, breaking down larger goals, or improving feedback for those goals can meaningfully improve your overall sense of forward movement.

3. Low Overall Perceived Goal Progress (avg across goals: 1.0–3.9)

Your results suggest **low overall perceived progress** across your goals. Taken together, your goals may not currently provide a strong sense of movement or accomplishment. Importantly, this does not mean you lack ability, motivation, or commitment. Research shows that when progress is difficult to detect across multiple goals, people often feel discouraged even while exerting substantial effort.

Low overall progress often reflects a goal system dominated by large, long-term, or abstract goals with limited short-term feedback. In such cases, people may be doing many “right” things without experiencing enough reinforcement to sustain motivation. Over time, this can undermine confidence and make continued effort feel exhausting or unrewarding.

If there is wide variation across goals, it is usually most effective to begin with the goals that feel most stalled or opaque, rather than trying to overhaul the entire goal system. Restructuring those goals into smaller, more manageable steps, improving progress monitoring, or adjusting timelines and expectations can create more frequent experiences of success. Even modest increases in perceived progress for one or two key goals can generate motivational spillover, strengthening persistence and confidence across the entire goal system.

Goal Approach Orientation

Goal items:

I think about this goal as something I want to approach, obtain, or get (add)
This goal is something positive I want to move toward (add)
This goal is something negative I want to keep away from (reverse score: 7=1, 6=2, 5=3, 4=4, 3=5, 2=6, 7=1, and then add)
I think about this goal as something I want to avoid, escape, or prevent (reverse score: 7=1, 6=2, 5=3, 4=4, 3=5, 2=6, 7=1, and then add)

Use Existing Goal Approach Interpretive Statements!

Individual Goal Self-Concordance Feedback

To score add items 1 and 2; with items 3 & 4, first reverse score then add; divide total by 4.
I pursue this goal because it is enjoyable or engaging (**add**)
I pursue this goal because it matters to me (**add**)
I pursue this goal because someone else wants me to or because the situation seems to demand it (**reverse score**: 7=1, 6=2, 5=3, 4=4, 3=5, 2=6, 7=1, and then add)
I pursue this goal because I think it is something that I should do, even if I don't want to (**reverse score**: 7=1, 6=2, 5=3, 4=4, 3=5, 2=6, 7=1, and then add)

1. High Goal Self-Concordance (avg item scores of 6.0–7.0)

Your results suggest that this goal is **highly self-concordant**—you pursue it because it feels meaningful, personally important, or genuinely engaging. This is a strong and adaptive motivational pattern. Research on the self-concordant model shows that goals grounded in intrinsic interest or personal values are experienced as self-chosen rather than imposed, and are therefore more likely to sustain effort over time.

Highly self-concordant goals tend to support the basic psychological needs, including *autonomy* (a sense of volition and choice), *competence* (feeling effective), and *relatedness* (feeling connected to others or to something meaningful). When these needs are met, motivation is more resilient, setbacks are easier to tolerate, and goal pursuit is often accompanied by positive affect rather than pressure or resentment.

This pattern suggests that your goal is well integrated with your values and sense of self. To build on this strength, it can be useful to periodically reflect on *why* this goal matters to you and how it expresses who you are or who you want to become. Doing so helps preserve self-concordance over time, especially as circumstances change or the goal becomes more demanding.

2. Moderate Goal Self-Concordance (avg item scores of 4.0–5.9)

Your results suggest **moderate self-concordance**. This means that your goal is motivated partly by personal interest or values, but also partly by a sense of obligation, expectation, or “should.” This is a common and understandable pattern, particularly for goals embedded in work, family, or social roles.

Research indicates that goals at this level can be pursued effectively, but motivation may be less stable. When effort is driven partly by external pressures or internalized demands, people are more vulnerable to fatigue, guilt, or disengagement—especially during stressful periods. At the same time, the presence of some intrinsic or identified motivation provides a foundation that can be strengthened.

One helpful strategy is to actively reconnect the goal to personally meaningful reasons. This might involve asking how the goal aligns with your values, how it serves something you care about, or how it contributes to longer-term aims. Reframing a “should” goal in terms of what it enables—rather than what it demands—can increase its self-concordance and make effort feel more voluntary and energizing.

3. Low Goal Self-Concordance (avg item scores of 1.0–3.9)

Your results suggest **low self-concordance** for this goal. This means that the goal is likely pursued primarily because of obligation, pressure, or external expectations rather than personal enjoyment or identification. Importantly, this does *not* mean the goal is unimportant or misguided. Many necessary or socially constrained goals (e.g., work, caregiving, health requirements) initially feel this way.

However, research consistently shows that when goals are experienced as controlled—stemming from external demands or a sense of “I should”—they are less likely to satisfy basic psychological needs. As a result, effort may feel draining, motivation may depend heavily on pressure, and persistence may weaken once external incentives or accountability are reduced.

There are several ways to respond to low self-concordance. One approach is *integration*: identifying aspects of the goal that connect to your own values, interests, or longer-term aspirations. Even small shifts—clarifying what *you* gain from pursuing the goal, or choosing *how* you pursue it—can increase feelings of autonomy. Another approach is *goal adjustment*: if a goal feels chronically misaligned with who you are, it may be worth reconsidering its scope, form, or priority. In some cases, replacing or supplementing the goal with more self-concordant aims can protect motivation and well-being.

When goals feel more self-chosen and personally meaningful, they are far more likely to support sustained effort, psychological need satisfaction, and lasting change.

Overall Goal Self-Concordance Feedback

To score: Add goal self-concordance scores for each goal and divide by the number of goals (4?)

1. High Overall Goal Self-Concordance (avg across goals: 6.0–7.0)

Your results suggest **high overall self-concordance** across your goals. Taken together, your goals are largely pursued because they feel personally meaningful, engaging, or aligned with your values, rather than because of pressure or obligation. Research on the self-concordant model shows that when people's goal systems are predominantly self-chosen, motivation tends to be more durable and self-sustaining over time.

A highly self-concordant goal structure is especially supportive of the basic psychological needs emphasized by self-determination theory: *autonomy* (experiencing choice and volition), *competence* (feeling effective), and *relatedness* (feeling connected to others or to something that matters). When many goals support these needs, people often experience their lives as more coherent, energized, and internally guided rather than fragmented or externally driven.

This pattern suggests that your goals are generally well integrated with your sense of self. To maintain this strength, it can be useful to periodically check whether your goals continue to reflect what matters most to you—especially as roles, responsibilities, or life circumstances change. Preserving alignment across goals helps protect motivation and well-being over the long term.

2. Moderate Overall Goal Self-Concordance (avg across goals: 4.0–5.9)

Your results suggest **moderate overall self-concordance** in your goal system. This means that, on average, your goals are motivated by a mix of personal values and interests alongside obligation, expectations, or external demands. This is a very common pattern, particularly for people balancing meaningful pursuits with responsibilities that are less freely chosen.

At this level, motivation can be effective but uneven. Some goals may feel energizing and self-expressive, while others feel effortful or pressured. Research suggests that when goal systems include both self-concordant and more controlled goals, overall motivation may fluctuate, and psychological need satisfaction may depend heavily on which goals are most salient at a given time.

If your individual goals vary widely in self-concordance, it is often most helpful to focus on the specific goals that feel most driven by “shoulds” or external pressure. Strengthening personal identification with those goals—or adjusting how they are pursued—can increase the self-concordance of the overall goal system more effectively than broad, global changes.

3. Low Overall Goal Self-Concordance (avg across goals: 1.0–3.9)

Your results suggest **low overall self-concordance** across your goals. Taken together, your goals may be experienced primarily as obligations, demands, or expectations imposed from outside yourself or from internalized pressures rather than as expressions of your own values or interests. Importantly, this does not mean your goals are unimportant or avoidable—many necessary life goals fall into this category.

However, research consistently shows that when a large portion of a person’s goal system is experienced as controlled, basic psychological needs are less likely to be met. As a result, effort may feel draining, motivation may rely on pressure or guilt, and persistence may be difficult to sustain over time. When many goals lack self-concordance, people may feel disconnected from their own agency or sense of choice in their lives.

If your goals differ substantially in self-concordance, it is often most effective to begin with the **least self-concordant goals**. Exploring whether these goals can be better integrated with your values, pursued in more autonomous ways, or adjusted in scope or priority can meaningfully improve your overall motivational climate. In some cases, increasing the presence of even a few highly self-concordant goals can have powerful ripple effects, strengthening autonomy, well-being, and sustained engagement across life domains.

Individual Goal Meaning Feedback

To score just add items and divide by 4.

- This goal gives me a sense of purpose
- This goal makes me feel that my life is significant
- This goal helps me feel that my life has meaning
- This goal helps me understand the direction of my life

1. High Goal Meaningfulness (avg item scores of 6.0–7.0)

Your results suggest that this goal is experienced as **highly meaningful**. You see it as contributing to a sense of purpose, personal significance, and overall direction in your life. Research on meaning in life shows that when goals are experienced in this way, they help

organize experience, provide coherence, and connect daily actions to something larger and enduring.

This pattern suggests that the goal functions as more than a task or objective—it serves as an *anchor for meaning*, helping you understand *why* you do what you do and where your life is heading. Goals that are experienced as meaningful are strongly associated with psychological well-being, life satisfaction, and positive emotion, and they can buffer against distress during difficult periods. In this sense, meaningful goals translate abstract values and purposes into concrete, actionable forms.

To build on this strength, it can be helpful to protect and reaffirm the meaning associated with the goal over time—especially when progress is slow or obstacles arise. Periodically reflecting on how the goal expresses what you value, or how it contributes to the broader narrative of your life, can help sustain engagement and preserve its motivational power.

2. Moderate Goal Meaningfulness (avg item scores of 4.0–5.9)

Your results suggest a **moderate sense of meaningfulness** associated with this goal. This indicates that the goal provides some sense of direction or purpose, but may not consistently feel central to your life's meaning or significance. This is a common pattern, particularly for goals that are important or necessary but not fully integrated into one's broader sense of identity.

Research suggests that meaning is not an all-or-nothing experience; rather, goals can vary in the degree to which they contribute to coherence and purpose. At this level, the goal may feel worthwhile, yet its connection to your deeper values or long-term life direction may be unclear, underdeveloped, or situationally dependent.

One way to strengthen meaningfulness is to explicitly link the goal to a larger life narrative. This might involve reflecting on how the goal fits into the kind of person you want to be, the contributions you hope to make, or the life direction you are trying to establish. Clarifying these connections can help transform a goal from something you are pursuing into something that actively shapes your sense of meaning.

3. Low Goal Meaningfulness (avg item scores of 1.0–3.9)

Your results suggest **low perceived meaningfulness** for this goal. This means that the goal may not currently contribute much to your sense of purpose, life significance, or overall direction. Importantly, this does not imply that the goal lacks importance in a general or societal sense. Research distinguishes *importance* from *meaningfulness*: a goal can be seen as important or necessary without feeling personally meaningful.

When goals lack perceived meaning, they tend to provide little psychological nourishment. They may feel disconnected from one's values, life story, or sense of coherence, and as a result, effort can feel mechanical or draining. Over time, pursuing goals that do not contribute to meaning may limit their ability to support well-being or protect against distress.

There are two constructive responses to low goal meaningfulness. One is *meaning-making*—actively exploring whether and how the goal could be connected to something you care about, such as growth, contribution, or personal values. Another is *goal reevaluation*—considering whether this goal deserves its current level of time and energy, or whether other goals might better serve your sense of purpose and direction. Meaningful lives are often built not by pursuing more goals, but by aligning goals more closely with what makes life feel significant and coherent.

Overall Goal Meaning Feedback

To score: Add goal self-meaningfulness scores for each goal and divide by the number of goals (4?)

1. High Overall Goal Meaningfulness (avg across goals: 6.0–7.0)

Your results suggest that, taken together, your goals form a **highly meaningful goal structure**. On average, your goals contribute strongly to your sense of purpose, life significance, and overall direction. Research on meaning in life indicates that when multiple goals support meaning, people are more likely to experience coherence—a sense that different parts of life fit together in a purposeful way rather than feeling fragmented or chaotic (King et al., 2006; Emmons, 2009).

This pattern suggests that your goals are not just individually valued, but collectively organizing your life around what matters to you. When goal systems are meaningful at this level, they tend to support psychological well-being, positive emotion, and resilience in the face of stress. Progress on any one goal can reinforce a broader sense that one's life is moving in a meaningful direction.

To maintain this strength, it can be useful to periodically reflect on how your goals continue to fit together as circumstances change. If some goals feel less meaningful over time, small adjustments or clarifications can help preserve a sense of overall coherence and purpose.

2. Moderate Overall Goal Meaningfulness (avg across goals: 4.0–5.9)

Your results suggest **moderate overall meaningfulness** in your goal structure. This means that, taken together, your goals provide some sense of purpose and direction, but may not consistently contribute to a strong feeling that your life is deeply meaningful or coherent.

This is a common pattern, especially when people are balancing goals that vary in personal significance or are driven by different demands.

At this level, some of your goals may feel clearly meaningful, while others may feel more instrumental, obligatory, or disconnected from your broader values. Research suggests that meaning in life often emerges from how goals are organized as a system, not just from the presence of a few meaningful aims. When meaningful and less meaningful goals coexist, the overall sense of purpose may feel uneven or situational.

If your individual goals differ widely in meaningfulness, it may be more helpful to focus on the specific goals that feel least meaningful, rather than trying to increase meaning across all goals at once. Clarifying how certain goals fit into your life direction—or reconsidering their role—can often have a larger impact on your overall sense of meaning than broad, global changes.

3. Low Overall Goal Meaningfulness (avg across goals: 1.0–3.9)

Your results suggest **low overall meaningfulness** across your goals. Taken together, your goals may not be providing much sense of purpose, life significance, or clear direction. Importantly, this does not mean that your life lacks meaning or that your goals are unimportant in a general sense. Rather, it suggests that your current goal structure may not be strongly aligned with what makes life feel meaningful to you personally.

Research distinguishes between pursuing goals that are *important* or *necessary* and pursuing goals that actively contribute to meaning. When many goals feel low in meaningfulness, life can begin to feel fragmented, overly driven by external demands, or disconnected from one's deeper values and long-term direction.

If there is wide variation among your goals, it is often most productive to start with the specific goals that are lowest in meaningfulness. Exploring whether those goals can be reshaped, reframed, or deprioritized can help increase the meaningfulness of your overall goal system. Even increasing the meaningfulness of one or two key goals can create ripple effects, strengthening your sense of purpose and coherence across life domains

Individual Goal Control Satisfaction

To score just add items and divide by 4.

- This goal helps me feel generally competent
- This goal helps me feel capable in my abilities
- This goal helps me feel good about the decisions I make
- This goal helps me feel like I am in control of my life and actions

1. High Goal Control Satisfaction (avg item scores of 6.0–7.0)

Your results suggest that this goal provides **high control satisfaction**. Pursuing this goal helps you feel competent, capable, confident in your decisions, and generally in control of your life and actions. This is a strong and psychologically supportive pattern. Research suggests that when goals reinforce a sense of control—combining feelings of effectiveness with volitional choice—they tend to energize motivation and support persistence.

This pattern indicates that engaging with this goal affirms your belief that your actions matter and that you can influence outcomes through your own decisions and abilities. Goals that support control satisfaction often function as sources of confidence and stability, particularly during periods of challenge or uncertainty. When people feel both capable and agentic, effort is more likely to feel worthwhile rather than effortful.

To build on this strength, it can be useful to notice which aspects of the goal most strongly reinforce your sense of competence and good decision-making. Preserving these elements—such as clear feedback, meaningful choice, or skill use—can help maintain control satisfaction even as the goal becomes more complex or demanding.

2. Moderate Goal Control Satisfaction (avg item scores of 4.0–5.9)

Your results suggest **moderate control satisfaction** associated with this goal. This means that the goal supports feelings of competence and control at times, but not consistently. You may feel capable and confident in some situations, while at other times feeling uncertain, constrained, or less effective. This is a common pattern, especially for goals that involve learning, evaluation, or external constraints.

Research indicates that motivation is strongest when people feel both effective and self-directed. When control satisfaction is moderate, effort can be sustained, but confidence may fluctuate—particularly in response to setbacks or ambiguous feedback. In such cases, people may continue pursuing the goal, but with less ease or resilience.

One helpful strategy is to strengthen clear signals of effectiveness and choice. This might involve breaking the goal into steps that allow you to experience competence more regularly, seeking feedback that clarifies what you are doing well, or increasing your sense of agency in how the goal is pursued. Small increases in perceived control can substantially improve motivation and persistence.

3. Low Goal Control Satisfaction (avg item scores of 1.0–3.9)

Your results suggest **low control satisfaction** for this goal. This means that pursuing the goal may not currently support a sense of competence, confidence in decision-making, or personal control. Importantly, this does not mean that you lack ability or that the goal is

inherently unmanageable. Rather, it suggests that the goal may be structured or experienced in ways that limit feedback, choice, or opportunities to feel effective.

Research on motivation and self-regulation shows that when goals undermine control satisfaction, effort can feel draining or discouraging. People may feel that outcomes are driven more by external forces, rigid demands, or chance than by their own actions. Over time, this can reduce persistence and weaken confidence, even when individuals care deeply about the goal.

There are constructive ways to respond to low control satisfaction. One approach is *restructuring the goal* to increase experiences of competence—for example, by setting more achievable sub-goals or clarifying success criteria. Another is increasing *decision autonomy*, such as choosing methods, pacing, or strategies that better fit your strengths. In some cases, it may be important to reconsider whether the goal's demands or constraints are realistic. When goals are structured to support both capability and agency, they are far more likely to foster motivation, confidence, and sustained engagement.

Overall Goal Control Satisfaction

To score: Add goal control satisfaction scores for each goal and divide by the number of goals (4?)

1. High Overall Goal Control Satisfaction (avg across goals: 6.0–7.0)

Your results suggest **high overall control satisfaction** across your goals. Taken together, your goals tend to support a strong sense of competence, confidence in decision-making, and personal control over your life and actions. Research on motivation indicates that when people experience their goal system as supporting both effectiveness and agency, effort is more likely to feel energizing and sustainable rather than draining.

This pattern suggests that your goals collectively reinforce the belief that your actions matter and that you can influence important outcomes through your own choices and abilities. When control satisfaction is high across goals, people often experience greater resilience in the face of setbacks, clearer self-regulation, and a more stable sense of confidence that extends beyond any single goal.

To maintain this strength, it can be helpful to periodically review whether your goals continue to allow for meaningful choice, clear feedback, and opportunities to feel capable—especially as goals evolve or new demands are added. Preserving these features helps sustain control satisfaction over time.

2. Moderate Overall Goal Control Satisfaction (avg across goals: 4.0–5.9)

Your results suggest **moderate overall control satisfaction** across your goals. This means that, on average, your goals sometimes support feelings of competence and control, but these experiences may be inconsistent or uneven across different areas of your life. Some goals may feel empowering, while others feel constrained, ambiguous, or less responsive to your efforts.

At this level, motivation is often workable but fragile. Research suggests that when control satisfaction varies across goals, confidence and persistence may depend heavily on which goals are most salient at a given time. Success in some areas can bolster confidence, while frustration in others can undermine the overall sense of agency.

If your goals differ substantially in control satisfaction, it is often most productive to focus on the specific goals that provide the weakest sense of control. Strengthening those goals—by increasing clarity, autonomy, or opportunities to experience competence—can improve the motivational quality of your overall goal system more effectively than broad changes applied uniformly across goals.

3. Low Overall Goal Control Satisfaction (avg across goals: 1.0–3.9)

Your results suggest **low overall control satisfaction** across your goals. Taken together, your goals may not currently support a strong sense of competence, confident decision-making, or personal control. Importantly, this does not mean that you lack ability or motivation. Rather, research shows that when a goal system provides few opportunities to feel effective and agentic, people may experience effort as frustrating, constrained, or psychologically costly.

Low overall control satisfaction often reflects a goal structure dominated by external constraints, unclear success criteria, or limited opportunities for choice. In such contexts, people may feel that outcomes are shaped more by circumstances or demands than by their own actions. Over time, this can undermine persistence, confidence, and well-being—even when goals are valued or necessary.

If there is wide variation across goals, it is usually most effective to begin with the goals that feel most disempowering or uncontrollable, rather than attempting to change everything at once. Restructuring those goals to allow for clearer feedback, smaller achievable steps, or greater decision autonomy can meaningfully increase control satisfaction. Even modest improvements in one or two goals can have spillover effects, strengthening confidence and agency across the entire goal system.

Individual Goal Relatedness Satisfaction

To score just add items and divide by 4.

This goal helps me feel close to others
This goal helps me feel connected with others
This goal helps me feel cared for or loved by others

1. High Goal Relatedness Satisfaction (avg item scores of 6.0–7.0)

Your results suggest that this goal provides **high relatedness satisfaction**. Pursuing this goal helps you feel close to others, connected, and cared for or loved. This is a highly adaptive motivational pattern. According to self-determination theory, goals that support relatedness tend to enhance well-being, emotional security, and sustained engagement because they satisfy a fundamental human need to belong.

This pattern suggests that this goal is embedded in meaningful social connections. Effort toward the goal may feel emotionally rewarding in itself, not just because of outcomes, but because it strengthens bonds with others or affirms your place in valued relationships or communities. Goals that support relatedness often buffer stress and increase resilience, especially during difficult periods.

To build on this strength, it can be helpful to protect the relational aspects of the goal—maintaining opportunities for shared experiences, communication, or mutual support. Being intentional about these connections helps preserve the goal’s emotional and motivational benefits over time.

2. Moderate Goal Relatedness Satisfaction (avg item scores of 4.0–5.9)

Your results suggest **moderate relatedness satisfaction** associated with this goal. This means that the goal sometimes supports feelings of connection and closeness with others, but not consistently. You may feel socially supported in some contexts or moments, while at other times the goal feels more solitary or emotionally neutral.

Research suggests that when relatedness satisfaction is moderate, motivation can be sustained but may be less emotionally nourishing. The goal may involve others indirectly, or connections may depend on circumstances rather than being built into the goal itself. As a result, feelings of connection may fluctuate, particularly during periods of stress or reduced contact.

One way to strengthen relatedness satisfaction is to intentionally integrate social elements into the goal. This might involve sharing the goal with others, pursuing it collaboratively, or identifying how it contributes to relationships you value. Even small increases in social connection can enhance the goal’s motivational quality and emotional payoff.

3. Low Goal Relatedness Satisfaction (avg item scores of 1.0–3.9)

Your results suggest **low relatedness satisfaction** for this goal. This means that pursuing the goal may not currently support feelings of closeness, connection, or being cared for by others. Importantly, this does not mean the goal is unimportant or maladaptive. Many goals—especially those that are private, task-focused, or highly individual—initially feel this way.

However, self-determination theory suggests that when goals consistently fail to meet relatedness needs, effort can feel isolating or emotionally draining. Over time, this can weaken motivation and reduce the sense that goal pursuit is emotionally rewarding, even when progress is being made.

There are constructive ways to respond to low relatedness satisfaction. One approach is *connection-building*—finding ways to share the goal with others, seek encouragement, or situate the goal within a relational context. Another approach is *goal balancing*—ensuring that other goals in your life more strongly support connection and belonging. When people meet their relatedness needs somewhere in their goal system, motivation and well-being are more likely to be sustained.

Overall Goal Relatedness Satisfaction

To score: Add goal relatedness satisfaction scores for each goal and divide by the number of goals (4?)

1. High Overall Goal Relatedness Satisfaction (avg across goals: 6.0–7.0)

Your results suggest **high overall relatedness satisfaction** across your goals. Taken together, your goals tend to support strong feelings of connection, closeness, and being cared for by others. Research grounded in self-determination theory indicates that when multiple goals satisfy relatedness needs, people are more likely to experience emotional security, well-being, and sustained motivation.

This pattern suggests that your goal system is socially embedded rather than isolating. Pursuing your goals likely reinforces your sense of belonging—to relationships, groups, or communities that matter to you. When relatedness satisfaction is high across goals, effort often feels emotionally rewarding, and challenges are easier to tolerate because they are buffered by supportive connections.

To maintain this strength, it can be helpful to periodically reflect on how your goals continue to foster connection as circumstances change. Protecting time and space for relationships within goal pursuit helps preserve both motivation and well-being over time.

2. Moderate Overall Goal Relatedness Satisfaction (avg across goals: 4.0–5.9)

Your results suggest **moderate overall relatedness satisfaction** across your goals. This means that, on average, your goals provide some sense of connection and closeness, but these experiences may be uneven or inconsistent across different areas of your life. Some goals may feel relationally rich, while others feel more solitary or emotionally neutral.

At this level, motivation is generally workable, but the emotional nourishment provided by your goal system may be variable. Research suggests that when relatedness satisfaction differs across goals, people may feel connected in some contexts but isolated in others, which can affect overall well-being and persistence.

If your individual goals vary widely in relatedness satisfaction, it is often most effective to focus on the specific goals that feel most isolating. Strengthening the relational aspects of those goals—by involving others, seeking support, or clarifying how the goal contributes to valued relationships—can enhance the overall social quality of your goal system more effectively than broad changes applied across all goals.

3. Low Overall Goal Relatedness Satisfaction (avg across goals: 1.0–3.9)

Your results suggest **low overall relatedness satisfaction** across your goals. Taken together, your goals may not currently support strong feelings of connection, closeness, or being cared for by others. Importantly, this does not mean that relationships are unimportant to you or that your goals are misguided. Rather, it suggests that your current goal system may be structured in ways that provide limited opportunities for social connection.

Self-determination theory suggests that when a person's goals consistently fail to satisfy relatedness needs, effort can feel isolating and emotionally taxing. Over time, this may reduce motivation and increase vulnerability to stress or disengagement, even when goals are being pursued competently and with effort.

If there is substantial variation across your goals, it is usually most productive to begin with the goals that are lowest in relatedness satisfaction. Exploring ways to make those goals more socially connected—through collaboration, sharing, or seeking emotional support—can meaningfully improve your overall experience. In addition, ensuring that at least some goals in your life strongly support relatedness can help buffer the emotional demands of more solitary pursuits.